

## Nexus S in space

Google used weather balloons to send seven Nexus S phones 100,000 feet above earth to check its performance at that altitude

## 60 million tabs

Users who installed Google's Chrome for a Cause extension opened 60 million tabs between December 15 and 19 which raised \$1 million

as you do not have to go through map menus to adjust volume while you are driving. It has an SD card with Indian maps. It runs on Windows CE 5 operating system.

## PERFORMANCE

Garmin PND's were the best amongst the lot. Voice navigation was quite good. Once the GPS location was locked, which did not take much time, it hardly lost the connection. The 1460 spoke out names of the street, while the 715 and 215 were not very good with street names. Navigating the menu of Garmin PNDs was quite easy as compared to the others. Wider screen 1460 and 715 were comparatively easier to operate from the drivers seat than the nuvi 215. The robust sub categorisation in the POI can be very overwhelming for some, but it is quite good. The visibility of navigational map from the drivers position is quite good and 3D mode gives you a map with the locations of buildings, banks/atms, hospitals etc.

Various details such as route overview, speed, changing views, etc is neatly displayed on the screen. Pairing your phone with the Nuvi 1460, Nuvi 715 was a breeze.

SatGuide PNDs such as Mio C230, Moov 560 and Moov 200 were devices which we found quite difficult to adapt to. Locking the GPS location proved to be an issue with Moov 200 and it

took ages. Mio 560 with its 5-inch wide screen is impressive as far as

navigation goes, but the problem lies in the user interface, which is very user - unfriendly. For instance, while finding a POI, we were first asked to enter the City's name before it populated its POIs. This seemed ridiculous as the GPS had already locked the location. Voice commands were decent, but the 3D view on the maps was nowhere close to Garmin's 3D maps. POI subcategories are quite exhaustive, but it involves a lot of clicks to get to your POI. The resistive keypad response is bad and while you are driving, there are bound to be vibrations which will result in a lot of misspelled words. This can get frustrating.

Blaupunkt had the same underlying user interface and OS as the SatGuide PNDs, but operating it was slightly better. User interface though is very boring to look at for such a good looking PND.

MapMyIndia (MMI hereon) devices were all very impressive on paper, but let us down with their performance. The lower-end Lx130 was perhaps the most consistent performer, with good lock-down and error-free navigation. However, the voice navigation on the MMI devices left a lot to be desired. For one, during our GPS-testing trip, the Garmin PNDs on the front seat were completely masking the puny sound coming out of the Lx130. And while we noticed the Garmin devices warning about turns a good 200 metres in advance, the MMI device usually instructed about 100 metres before the turn. The detail was also missing in the instructions. A "turn-left" or "turn-right" was all that MMI devices mustered at most turns. The "have a nice trip" and "turn right from the crossing and take the first left" of the Garmin left us thoroughly impressed.

Besides this, the Vx140 was very poor at satellite lock-down, losing connection the moment we drew it away from the window. The



Garmin Nuvi 715

locking performance of the high-end Zx150 Deluxe was the best in the category, but unfortunately, we couldn't get voice navigation to work on our faulty test piece.

## WINNERS

Garmin nuvi 1460 emerged as the Best Performer in our testing with the nuvi 215 following closely. SatGuide's Mio C230 won the Best Buy, thanks to its sub-₹10,000 pricing.

On the whole we observed that PNDs with larger screen sizes were much better to operate than their small screen counterparts. The scores of the 4.7-inch and 5-inch PNDs proves that. The only differentiating aspect that separates the good from the bad is the user friendliness of the device. A good PND is one that can be used by anyone who is driving your car and requires faster adaptation.

In our tests we found that Garmin and MapMyIndia PNDs fulfilled that need. SatGuide should seriously consider redesigning the UI to make it more user-friendly. Bells and whistles such as bluetooth connectivity for phones, media playback are welcome additions, although we fail to understand the idea behind adding a video player on a PND. Not only can it be very distracting for the driver but we don't see a reason to shell out the extra money for it.

We would have loved to see a few PNDs which can take voice commands instead of manually having to enter them. Hopefully, we will get them during our next GPS comparison test with a more contemporary OS. **d**

**BEST BUY**  
**digit**  
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SatGuide Mio C230